



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05535) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2025**

Courses Audience: **57**

Responses Received: **56**

Response Ratio: **98.2%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

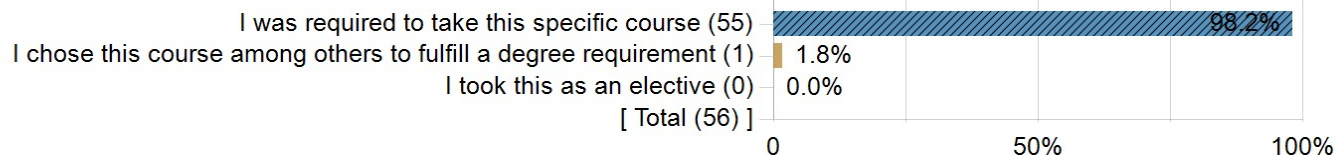
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

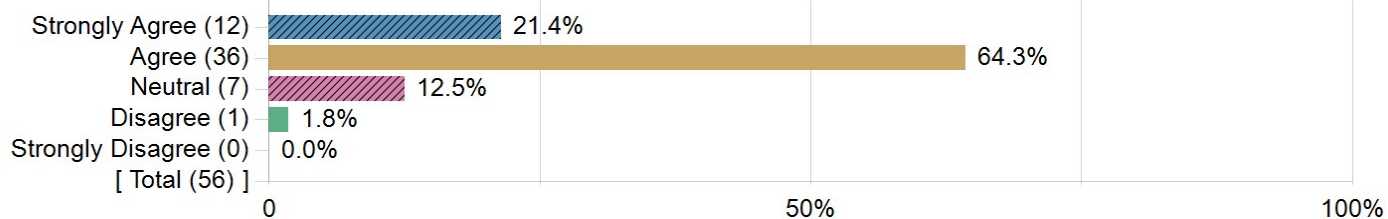
Creation Date: **Friday, May 9, 2025**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



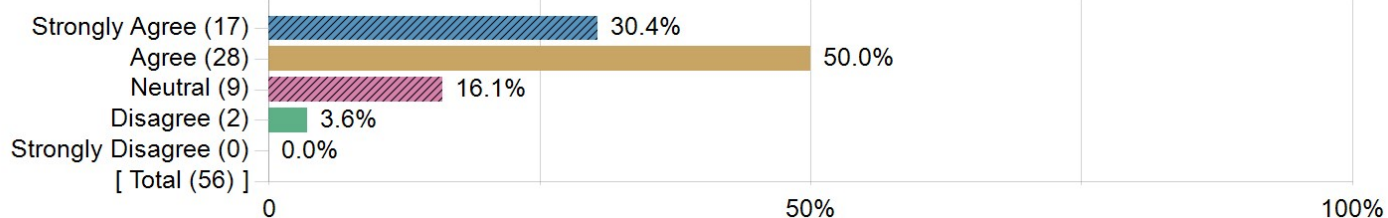
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.05

The course was well organized.



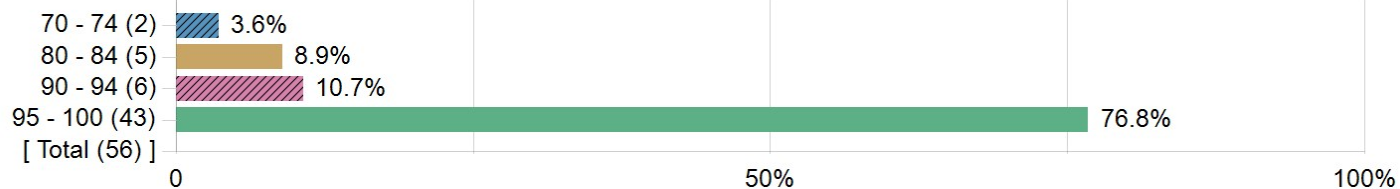
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.07

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



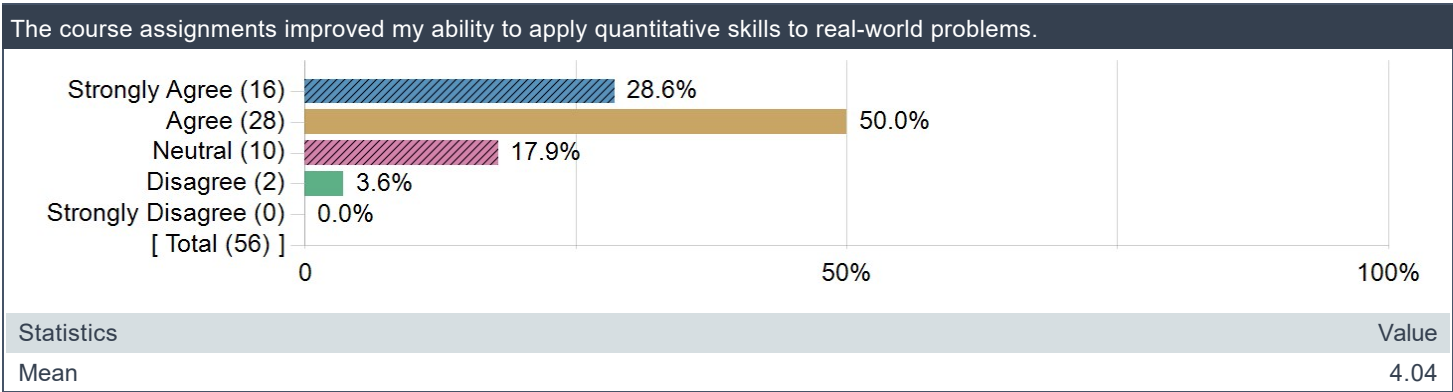
Statistics

Value

Mean

95.45

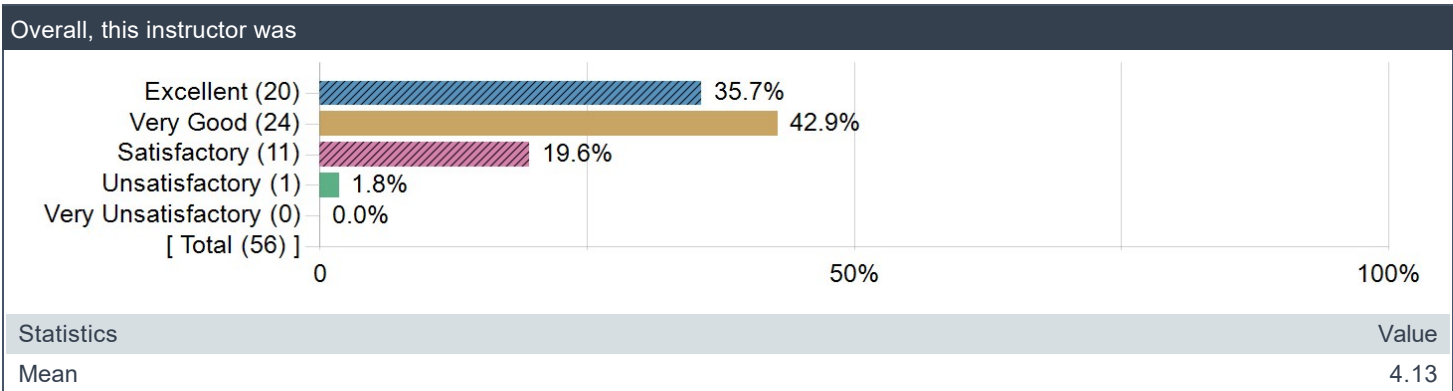
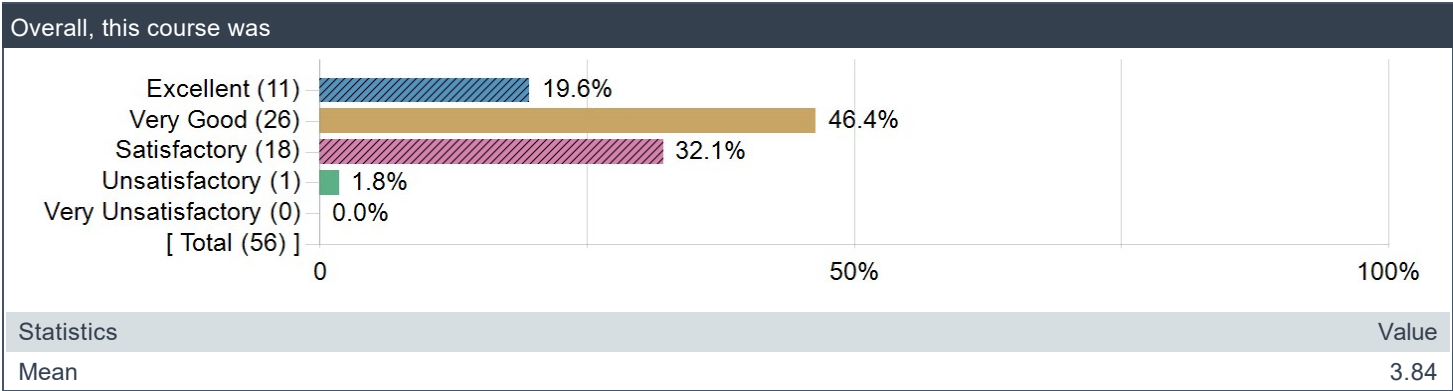
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



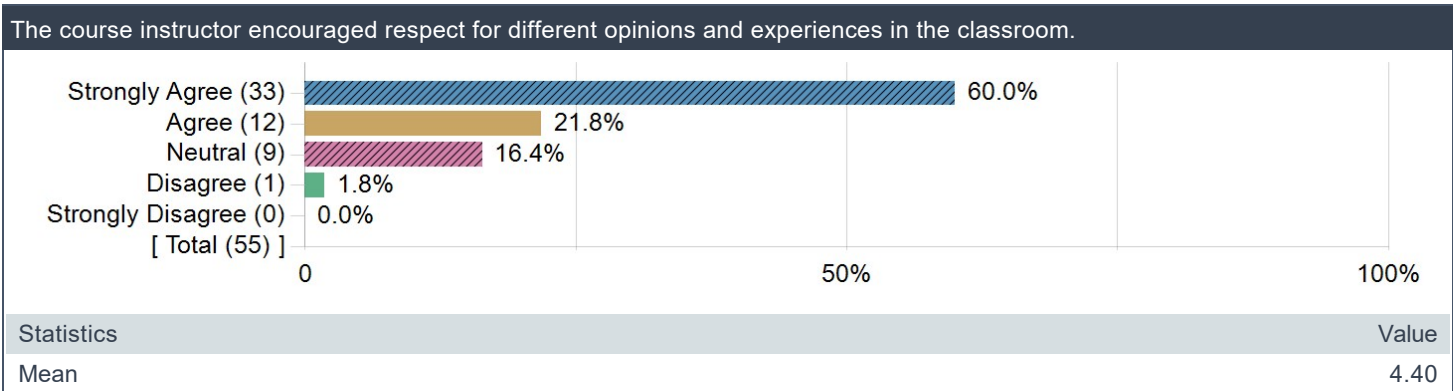
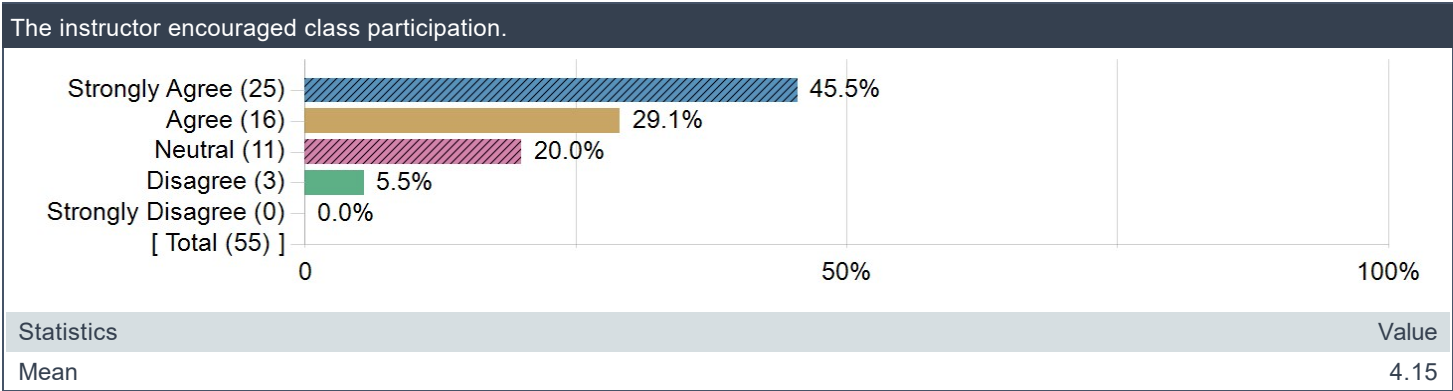
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	33.9%	53.6%	8.9%	3.6%	0.0%	56	4.18
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	62.5%	30.4%	7.1%	0.0%	0.0%	56	4.55
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	32.1%	51.8%	10.7%	5.4%	0.0%	56	4.11
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	28.6%	32.1%	28.6%	8.9%	1.8%	56	3.77
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	37.5%	46.4%	12.5%	3.6%	0.0%	56	4.18

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The interpretation of the R models were helpful to increase my stats knowledge.
Professor Bolfarine's office hours were extremely helpful. As the course progressed and got more difficult to understand, Professor Bolfarine would be open and patient to helping during office hours.
I liked that he posted the in class R scripts.
Homework was probably the best.
The office hours helped me immensely. Specifically, Pedro was super helpful.
The homeworks having multiple attempts helped me grasp different concepts in class.
I think that the in call work and using a r for real world application helped
The homeworks and checkpoint quizzes
Great walkthroughs/explanation videos over practice tests
Working back and fourth between RStudio and the class slides was helpful for active learning.
I think that having the practice exams and homeworks as preparations for the midterms helped me succeed. Also, it is so much better that the tests are on paper; this makes the class fairer and slightly less stressful.
Liked how he posted the recordings
The in class lectures and homeworks were helpful. The recordings were effective as well.
The in class activities were very helpful and help me learn the best
The TA review sessions
Homeoworks and Practice Exams
In class quizzes, practice exams
Going to office hours to review the quizzes taken in class and reviewing recorded lectures.
Professor Bolfraine is really good at explaining topics
The high accessibility of the course from the professor to the textbook made learning in this class interesting and applicable beyond the one class slot a week. Combining these two features enabled me to grasp the material in a much more convenient way than I otherwise would have been able to. This is particularly true with the second half of the class and being able to receive the guidance I got to help my learning in this class.
He explains very well and really cares about his students.
TA office hours were so helpful! I really like how the Dr. Bolfarine was very responsive to emails, and genuinely wanted students to succeed.
The most effective part of the course was the lectures to me when the material was easy to learn.
The weekly quizzes really kept me in check.
The in-class quizzes were helpful to stay on top of the material.
The slides were good.
Homework assignments and lecture recordings
N/A
In class practices
the proffesor was very engaged with the class
The homework, I like that we had multiple attempts to figure the right answer out
The homework assignments and in class quizzes were helpful on building upon what we learned in class.
Real world examples
The class lectures were very helpful in going over content.
I think the homeworks were effective, but the quizzes were the most effective because they forced me to fully understand the concepts from the week prior before moving on to the next topic. They were also great for studying for exams.
Very good lectures in class. explains well and really helps students out. Also, the class recordings are helpful & TA review.
Having the content posted and a timeline of the lectures ahead of time
The aspects of the course that were most effective in helping my learning were the in class checkpoint quizzes because the

Comments
question were very similar to the exam questions at least in the format of them.
The practice in class was very helpful on top of the office hours.
His lectures helped. The quizzes helped test your knowledge.
The slides were very helpful as well as his lectures on the slides were great as well
The quizzes every week.
I like how our professor was very nice and willing to help anyone.
The TA review sessions
I think that the review session held every Monday helped me understand the material on a more basic level. Having this resource helped students understand the material outside of the r studio presentations in class which were also helpful.
Use of R-Studio.
Understanding and helpful professor

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
The last few units were covered quickly and were by far the hardest topics.
The quizzes were most challenging. Oftentime, they were harder than what we did in class and I did not like the.
We had 'check for understanding' quizzes for every class, but we could not go back and review these easily. Further, I feel like what we needed to do for the homework and what we needed to know for the quizzes / exams were very different.
Well, I felt that the storytelling was actually a really good way to learn and practice. By doing the storytelling, we were able to make sure that we had a good understanding of the concepts while working with our own scripts. I thought that felt more effective than the average class notes.
The r programming was by far the most difficult part of this course.
I think the lack of structure in lecture sometimes made me get lost. I would have to only go by the code or ask others for help. I think if lectures had a different flow I would understand it better.
I think that the quizzes were different from the homework and different from what we learned in class.
The checkpoint quizzes
Checkpoint Quizzes
I found the class very long/boring. Maybe adding in more group activities during class/breaks so that students can stay more attentive.
I think the Checkpoint Quiz assignment should be fixed. The midterm replaces them, and then most people are not going to study for them the night before. Also, it would be more accurate if they were on paper, etc.
N/a
The most challenging part was that we would use R Studio in class and for homeworks but would not have to use it on exams and quizzes. The majority of what we learned was through R Studio.
The quizzes I thought were very challenging. Going over the quiz answer the week after we take the quiz would be helpful to see and learn what I did wrong.
Quizzes; didn't seem to correlate as much with what we talked about in class or on the homework.
In class quizzes
Quizzes were pretty challenging, but they were accurate to the exams.
He can go off topic or repeat course content from the prior week even if we already did it so hard to follow
The in class quizzes were the most challenging aspect of this course to me. I found this challenging due to the writing and difficulty not always being consistent even with the review questions. For students to address thus, I would be sure to make sure you know the process behind the concepts beyond their in class application.
The quizzes were challenging and very stressful to have before every class.
The content after the second exam was very hard to grasp. I feel like I had trouble with staying on top of things.
The most challenging part of the course was conceptual questions on the exams and quizzes. This was because we didn't get much practice on these and one thing to help for the future would be to have more of an emphasis on these questions.
I found the first exam challenging because of how chaotic the structure of it was.

Comments
I didn't find anything too challenging.
The homeworks were not related to the tests or the lectures at all. The test has no coding, yet the homework was almost entirely coding. Make the homeworks more like the tests so students can learn through the homework instead of feeling like they are doing busy work that they will never see again.
Lectures can be confusing sometimes.
N/A
n/a
the application of the subjects on the test
The most challenging aspects were the in-class quizzes.
I found it very hard to pay attention in the class. The lectures were very all over the place, with almost an hour spent on simple topics and barely any time spent on the more important topic. I would suggest trying to work through certain concepts quicker and place a greater emphasis on the examples from the second half of class so we do not run out of time.
N/A
The quizzes were very difficult, and I believe one homework assignment over each quiz didn't sufficiently prepare us. I believe more in class preparation is necessary to do good.
I think the second half of the course got confusing with all the coding. It was particularly annoying because the exams were on paper, so having to code on the homeworks felt unnecessary.
A lot of information and the practice test not being structured the same (no r coding) because they were from last year. In class quizzes were very challenging and would be better implemented as a class led activity to review previous weeks.
In class quizzes were challenging because it didn't feel like I always had a complete grasp of my concept by that point
The aspect of the course that I found most challenging was also the checkpoint quizzes because they aren't taken until a week after the topic is taught because the class is only once a week, so it made it a little difficult to try and recall what was learned the previous week. I think one thing that could be done to help would be to have the checkpoint quizzes at the end of the class that the topic is taught in.
Release the answers and explanations to the in-class quizzes from the beginning of class
It was hard to stay attentive during class.
Please turn the grades on so students are aware if they are doing well or not.
I found coding the most challenging and as we didn't use extensive R on the test
The real-world applications of this course, felt very redundant and mundane.
I would say just the course in general was difficult.
The second half of the course
I think the most challenging part of this course is the switch to only paper tests since you cannot use r studio to do quick calculations or run a model to answer questions but you must use what they give you. I think focusing more in class on how to apply the r studio scenarios to the new test format and provide practice tests without needing to use r studio.
The lessons often went long, and we had multiple extra videos to watch outside of class when we could have easily finished the lesson in class if the professor kept to the topics.
The fact that the whole semester we had to code, and didn't need to apply it for our exams. It felt like a waste of time when we could have focused more on the application.